COMPONENT · DEMONSTRATION KITCHEN

SMOKED EGGPLANT WITH TAHINI DRIZZLE AND FLAKE SALT

A smoked vegetable component finished with a cold-emulsified tahini drizzle. The eggplant is smoked whole, peeled and trimmed before weighing, so the grams on the card are the trimmed edible mass that reaches the plate, not the as-purchased mass. The drizzle seizes and loosens as it is stirred; endpoint is texture, not time.

TOTAL TIME
22 minutes
Active 22 min
Inactive 0 min

DIFFICULTY
Intermediate
Smoked component with a cold emulsified drizzle

YIELD / PORTION
598 g usable
74 portions at 8.0 g

STORAGE
Unconfirmed
House SOP required

R&D — NOT RELEASED FOR PRODUCTION. Approved holding and storage conditions, container labeling, use-by basis and discard rule; Second-cook reproduction with chef-approved tolerances for yield, texture and portioning; Explicit production release for this exact final version.

DEMO-002 · v0.1 · 2026-11-02
Equipment / tested load: Smoker with hickory chips, wire rack, bowl, scale readable to 0.1 g, small mixing bowl, spoon, warm plates, portion scale. One 611 g input batch only.
Allergens: Sesame (tahini). Simulated label review lists no additional declared allergens. Shared utensils need house cross-contact controls; no free-from claim.
Percentage basis: Smoked eggplant = 100% = 420 g; tahini = 100% = 90 g within its own component.

INGREDIENTS

INGREDIENT	WEIGHT	VOLUME	SCALING %
For the smoked eggplant			
E1 · Japanese eggplant, smoked over hickory chips, peeled and cut into 6 cm lengths Smoked whole, then peeled and trimmed; weight is the trimmed edible mass. Volume is a generic proxy, not a sourced conversion; weight authoritative.	420 g	≈ two medium eggplants (pieces)	100%
E2 · Grapeseed oil brushed on the grill rack before smoking Not supplied; weighed at the station.	18 g	—	4.3%
For the tahini drizzle			
T1 · Unhulled tahini, stirred to a pouring consistency Step 3. Volume is a labeled proxy; weight authoritative.	90 g	≈ 6.0 tbsp (US)	100%
T2 · Lemon juice Step 3. Volume is a labeled proxy; weight authoritative.	30 g	≈ 2.0 tbsp (US)	33.3%
T3 · Cold water Step 3. Volume is a labeled proxy; weight authoritative.	45 g	≈ 3.0 tbsp (US)	50%

INGREDIENT	WEIGHT	VOLUME	SCALING %
For the finish			
F1 · Flake salt, Maldon-style Not supplied; weighed at the station.	6 g	—	100%
F2 · Black pepper, coarsely cracked Not supplied; weighed at the station.	2 g	—	33.3%
Measured usable yield	598 g	—	—

Basis: Smoked eggplant = 100% = 420 g; tahini = 100% = 90 g within its own component. Input 611 g. Measured usable output 598 g. Transfer loss 13 g. Complete portions 74. Remainder 6 g not portioned. Volume recorded for 4 of 7 ingredients; a researched volume is an approximation, not a measured spoonful. Weigh ingredients.

METHOD

SMOKE

1. Light the smoker with hickory chips and bring it to approximately 105 °C. Lay the eggplant lengths (E1) on the wire rack in a single layer, leaving space between each piece so smoke reaches every side. Brush the rack with grapeseed oil (E2) first so nothing sticks. Smoke for 22 minutes from the first chip, turning the eggplant once at 11 minutes, until the skin is blistered all over and the flesh gives way under a spoon tip. Consequential equipment: smoker, hickory chips, wire rack. Endpoint: blistered skin, tender flesh, no raw resistance.
2. Transfer the smoked eggplant (E1) to a bowl, cover it tightly, and rest for 8 minutes so steam loosens the skin. Peel the skin off in strips and discard it. Cut the flesh into 6 cm lengths, weigh the trimmed flesh on the 0.1 g scale, and record the actual mass; do not backfill a guessed number if the trim differs from the reference.

   Resist the urge to rinse the eggplant after smoking; rinsing washes the smoke off the flesh.

EMULSIFY

3. Put the tahini (T1) in a small bowl. Add the lemon juice (T2) and the cold water (T3) in two additions, stirring between each addition. The mixture will seize and thicken before it loosens; keep stirring until it reaches a pouring consistency that coats a spoon and holds a trail for 3 seconds. The tahini basis is fixed at 90 g, so adjust only with lemon juice or water, never with more tahini, and record any adjustment in the trial notes.
4. Taste the finished drizzle for balance. It should taste of tahini and lemon, with the salt coming from the flake salt at finish, not from the drizzle. Log any failed endpoint for trial review.

   Cold water loosens the drizzle faster than warm water and keeps it from breaking.

FINISH & PORTION

5. Arrange the smoked eggplant lengths on a warm plate in a single layer. Drizzle the tahini mixture evenly over the cut surfaces, about 8.0 g per portion. Sprinkle flake salt (F1) and cracked black pepper (F2) across the top immediately before service, so nothing sits in the salt long enough to draw moisture out of the eggplant.
6. Weigh each finished portion at 8.0 g and log the usable mass against the 598 g reference yield. Any portion outside 7.5 g to 8.5 g is re-weighed, not approximated. Record the actual usable mass and transfer loss on every trial.

   Portion weight is the control; plating arrangement is not.

PROCESS CONTROLS

Emulsification — Tahini, lemon juice and cold water are stirred to a pouring consistency; no heat

Smoking — Hickory chips at approximately 105 C, eggplant turned once at 11 minutes, smoke until skin blisters and flesh yields

LABELING

product name: Smoked eggplant with tahini drizzle

batch or date code: NEEDS CHEF CONFIRMATION - date code convention is not set

use by basis: NEEDS CHEF CONFIRMATION - no approved shelf-life basis located

storage instruction: NEEDS CHEF CONFIRMATION - approved storage conditions and container are unresolved

allergen declaration: Sesame

preparer or station: NEEDS CHEF CONFIRMATION - preparer and station are not recorded

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SERVICE & PLATING

Serve warm on warm plates, as a component, not a standalone dish. No verified plating photograph is available; plating instructions are the controlling record.

HOLDING & STORAGE

Unresolved: approved conditions, container, label, use-by and discard rule. No shelf life is assigned. Production remains blocked.

SCALING & VARIATIONS

At factor 2: 840 g smoked eggplant, 36 g grapeseed oil, 180 g tahini, 60 g lemon juice and 90 g cold water. Run separate reference-size batches; do not double the smoker load or the smoking time. Finished yield is not guaranteed. No substitutions are approved.

CHECKS & CORRECTIVE ACTION

Check smoke endpoint, peel yield, drizzle consistency, salt distribution and portion weight on every trial. Record deviations for chef review. Recheck current supplier labels and house utensil controls. No validated food-safety critical control point is asserted; applicable controls await house SOP review.

VOLUME RESEARCH AND SOURCES

Volumes are researched approximations, not measurements; gram weights stay authoritative. Source 1: USDA FoodData Central, Tahini, sesame butter, https://fdc.nal.usda.gov/food-details/169086/nutrients, accessed 2026-10-26, listing approximately 15 g per tablespoon in US measures (1 US tbsp = 14.79 mL), so 90 g of tahini is approximately 6.0 tbsp. Source 2: USDA FoodData Central, Lemon juice, raw, https://fdc.nal.usda.gov/food-details/169566/nutrients, accessed 2026-10-26, listing approximately 15 g per tablespoon, so 30 g is approximately 2.0 tbsp and 45 g is approximately 3.0 tbsp. Units convention: US tablespoon throughout. Proxy status: rows T1, T2 and T3 use generic ratios because the purchased brands were not provided, so all three are labeled proxies rather than exact matches.

VOLUME ARITHMETIC AND ROUNDING

T1: 90 g divided by 15 g per US tbsp = 6.0 tbsp. T2: 30 g divided by 15 g per US tbsp = 2.0 tbsp. T3: 45 g divided by 15 g per US tbsp = 3.0 tbsp. Rounded to the nearest 0.1 tbsp. Where an exact measure is needed, weigh the ingredient and measure the spoon.

REQUIRED BEFORE PRODUCTION RELEASE

- Confirm holding/storage, labeling, use-by and discard SOP.
- Complete second-cook reproduction; approve yield, texture and portion tolerances.
- Obtain explicit chef release for the exact final version after controls are resolved.

Evidence: Fictional demonstration card. Original fictional notes and chef replies; no actual photo inspected. Ingredient weights, method and usable yield are simulated statements. Percentages, portion counts and factor-2 quantities are calculations. Household volumes are researched approximations derived from the cited public sources with their access dates, not measured spoonfuls.

Validation: One simulated batch; no real cook test and no production approval. New trial with no predecessor. Local demonstration only.

Filing: Local demonstration only. Proposed relative route: R&D / needs-confirmation. No remote write attempted.